administration and the army's presence, especially in Tawang. These documents enabled the Chinese to gradually comprehend the complexity of the boundary issue with India. As one of the Chinese representatives, Yang Gongsu, put it, 'This was the first time we saw the real picture.' [32] The Central Committee of the Communist Party of China set up an eleven-member committee consisting of representatives from the central government, the Tibetan local government and the PLA to guide the negotiators. [33] It was during a meeting of this Committee that Zhou Enlai decided that it would be better not to discuss the boundary issue with India since matters were yet unclear. He said that the discussion should be limited to issues that were mature for settlement.

India's preparation, in contrast with China's, left much to be desired. A detailed review of the happenings since 1950, and especially the implications of concessions made by India, on the legality of its rights and privileges in Tibet, were not examined. Information provided by the Consul General in Lhasa and the Political Officer in Gangtok were filed away. In one case, in late 1953, when Consul General S. Sinha wrote of the imminent danger to India as a result of 'Chinese designs on the north-eastern frontier', he was reprimanded by the Government of India for having fanciful ideas. Nehru recorded the following minute: 'It appears that Mr Sinha does not appreciate our policy fully. He should be enlightened.' [34] Ignoring inputs from Lhasa that the Chinese were studying all documents relating to the India–China boundary in Tibet, a policy note from the prime minister on 3 December 1953 decided once and for all that the question of the frontier would not be raised or discussed during the forthcoming India–China talks about Tibet, because it was already a settled issue. [35] India wanted a limited discussion on the facilities it enjoyed in Tibet.